

strong as a lion Go to previous.

strong as an ox Go to strong as a horse.

the **strong, silent type** a strong, quiet man. ☐ *Clark looks like the strong, silent type. Actually he is slightly deaf and that's fat, not muscle.*

strong-arm tactics force; the use of force. ☐ *No more strong-arm tactics. You need to be more subtle.* ☐ *Strong-arm tactics are out. The boss says be gentle and don't hurt anybody.*

struggle against someone or something to strive or battle against someone or something. ☐ *There is no point in struggling against me. I will win out.* ☐ *He struggled against the disease for a year before he died.*

struggle along under something to make do as well as one can under a particular burden. ☐ *I will have to struggle along under these poor conditions for quite a while.* ☐ *I am sorry you have to struggle along under such burdens.*

struggle along (with someone or something) to make do as well as one can with someone or something. ☐ *I really need someone who can work faster, but I'll struggle along with Walter.* ☐ *We struggled along the best we could.*

struggle for something to strive to obtain something. ☐ *I was struggling for a law degree when I won the lottery.* ☐ *I had to struggle for everything that came my way.*

struggle on with something to make do as well as one can with something. ☐ *I will have to struggle on with the car that I have.* ☐ *We will struggle on with what we have, hoping for better someday.*

struggle through (something) to get through something in the best way possible. ☐ *I am going to struggle through this dull book to the very end.* ☐ *The course was dull, but I struggled through.*

struggle to do something to strive or battle to do something. ☐ *She struggled hard to meet her deadlines.* ☐ *We had to struggle to make ends meet.*

struggle to the death **1.** *Lit.* a bitter struggle ending in death. ☐ *The wolf and the elk fought in a struggle to the death.* **2.** *Fig.* a serious problem with someone or something; a difficult challenge. ☐ *I had a terrible time getting my car started. It was a struggle to the death, but it finally started.*

struggle with someone for something to fight with someone to obtain something. ☐ *Max struggled with Lefty for the gun, and it went off.* ☐ *Timmy struggled with Bobby for the bicycle, and finally David took it away from both of them.*

struggle with someone or something to fight or battle with someone or something. ☐ *Fred struggled with Tom for a while and finally gave in.* ☐ *Tom struggled with the disease for a while and finally succumbed to it.*

strum something on something to brush or play with the fingers some stringed instrument, such as a guitar. ☐ *She strummed a nice little melody on her guitar.* ☐ *He strummed the accompaniment on the guitar.*

strung out **1.** extended in time; overly long. ☐ *Why was that lecture so strung out? She talked and talked.* ☐ *It was strung out because there was very little to be said.* **2.** *Sl.* doped or drugged. ☐ *Bob acted very strangely—as if he*

were strung out or something. ☐ *I've never seen Bob or any of his friends strung out.*

strut around to stride around pompously. ☐ *Stop strutting around in your new jeans and get to work!* ☐ *Tex was strutting around, showing off his new boots.*

strut in(to some place) to stride pompously into a place. ☐ *He strutted into the house as if he owned the place.* ☐ *Betty strutted in and sat down.*

strut one's stuff *Sl.* to walk proudly and show off one's best features or talents. ☐ *Get out there on that stage and strut your stuff!* ☐ *I'm going to strut my stuff and become a star.*

strut out of some place to stride pompously or showily out of some place. ☐ *The clowns strutted out of the tent and joined the parade through the big top.* ☐ *Tex strutted out of the saloon and got on his horse.*

stub one's toe against something and **stub one's toe on something** to ram one's toe accidentally against some hard object. ☐ *Don't stub your toe against that brick in the path.* ☐ *Claire stubbed her toe against one of the legs of the sofa.* ☐ *I stubbed my toe on the bottom step.*

stub something out[†] to put out something, such as a cigarette or cigar, by crushing the burning end against a hard object. ☐ *Max stubbed his cigar out and tossed it into the street.* ☐ *He stubbed out his cigar.*

***stubborn as a mule** and ***obstinate as a mule** *Cliché* very stubborn. (*Also: **as ~**.) ☐ *I tried to convince Jake to go to the doctor, but he's as stubborn as a mule.* ☐ *For four years, Henry pestered his parents to let him learn the trumpet. They tried to talk him into some other, quieter instrument, but he was stubborn as a mule, and now he has a trumpet.*

(stuck) in a rut *Fig.* kept in an established way of living or working that never changes. ☐ *David felt like he was stuck in a rut, so he went back to school.* ☐ *Anne was tired of being in a rut, so she moved to Los Angeles.*

stuck in traffic to be caught in a traffic jam. ☐ *I am sorry I am late. I was stuck in traffic.* ☐ *Our taxi was stuck in traffic and I thought I would never get to the airport on time.*

***stuck on someone or something** **1.** *Lit.* attached, as if by glue, to someone or something. (*Typically: **be ~**; **become ~**; **get ~**.) ☐ *The gum is stuck on me. How do I get it off?* ☐ *The gum is stuck on the floor.* **2.** *Fig.* in love with someone or something; entranced with someone or something. (*Typically: **be ~**; **become ~**; **get ~**.) ☐ *Judy is really stuck on Jeff.* ☐ *She is stuck on herself.*

stuck on something **1.** *Fig.* to be locked into an idea, cause, or purpose. ☐ *Mary is really stuck on the idea of going to France this spring.* ☐ *You've proposed a good plan, Jane, but you're stuck on it. We may have to make some changes.*

3. *Fig.* to be confused by something, such as a puzzle or a task. (Typically: **be ~**; **become ~**; **get ~**.) ☐ *I'm stuck on this question about the tax rates.*

stuck with someone or something burdened with someone or something; left having to care for or deal with someone or something. ☐ *Please don't leave me stuck with your aunt. She talks too much.* ☐ *My roommate quit school and left me stuck with the telephone bill.*

study for something to try to learn in preparation for an examination. ☐ I have to study for my calculus exam. ☐ Have you studied for your exam yet?

study up on someone or something to learn all one can about someone or something. ☐ I have to study up on Abraham Lincoln in preparation for my speech. ☐ John studied up on seashells.

Stuff a sock in it! and **Put a sock in it!** *Inf.* Shut up! ☐ I've heard enough. Stuff a sock in it! ☐ Stuff a sock in it! You are a pain.

stuff and nonsense foolishness; foolish talk. ☐ Come on! Don't give me all that stuff and nonsense! ☐ I don't understand this book. It's all stuff and nonsense as far as I am concerned.

stuff one's face Go to fill one's face.

stuff someone or something **into** someone or something and **stuff** someone or something **in**^t to force someone or something into someone or something. ☐ The sheriff stuffed Tex into the tiny cell. ☐ He stuffed in some other prisoners, too. ☐ Donna got down her suitcase and stuffed her clothes in. ☐ The nurse stuffed the oatmeal into the old man faster than he could swallow it.

stuff someone or something **with** something to fill up someone or something with something. ☐ She stuffed the kids with pancakes and sent them to school. ☐ Dale stuffed the doll with fluffy material and gave it back to Timmy. ☐ He was afraid he would stuff himself with food as he usually did.

stuff someone's **head with** something to fill someone's brain with certain kinds of thoughts. ☐ Who has been stuffing your head with that nonsense? ☐ Tex thought that the government was stuffing peoples' heads with all sorts of propaganda.

stuff something **down** someone's **throat** *Fig.* to force someone to hear, learn, endure, etc., some kind of information. ☐ I don't like the nonsense they are stuffing down our throats. ☐ Please don't try to stuff those lies down our throats.

stuff something **down** something to force something down inside of something. ☐ Don stuffed the cauliflower leaves down the garbage disposal and turned it on. ☐ Timmy stuffed the leaves down the hole and covered them with dirt.

stuff something **up**^t to plug something by stuffing something in its opening. ☐ He stuffed the hole up with old newspapers. ☐ Liz stuffed up the hole with paper.

stuff something **up** something to force something upward or up into something. ☐ He tried to hide the book by stuffing it up the chimney. ☐ Sam stuffed the money he found up the downspout, where he thought no one would find it.

stuff the **ballot box** to fill a ballot box with illegal votes or with more votes than the number of actual voters. ☐ The politician was charged with stuffing the ballot box. ☐ The ballot box was stuffed with lots of votes for the crooked politician.

stumble across someone or something and **stumble (up)on** someone or something; **stumble into** someone or something to find someone or something, usually by accident. (See also **stumble into** someone or something.) ☐ I stumbled across an interesting book yesterday when I was

shopping. ☐ Guess who I stumbled into at the library yesterday? ☐ I got lucky and stumbled on the right answer.

stumble into someone or something to trip and lurch into someone or something. **1.** ☐ Not seeing the brick in the path, Carl tripped and stumbled into Alice. ☐ Jamie stumbled into the wall. **2.** Go to **stumble across** someone or something.

stumble on someone or something **1.** Go to **stumble across** someone or something. **2.** to trip over someone or something. ☐ There were three of us sleeping in the small tent. Each of us would stumble on the others whenever we went out or came in. ☐ I stumbled on the curb and twisted my ankle.

stumble over someone or something to trip over someone or something. ☐ Tom stumbled over Bill, who was napping on the floor. ☐ Don't stumble over the laundry basket.

stumble through something to get through a sequence of something awkwardly and falteringly. ☐ The cast stumbled through the first act and barely finished the second. ☐ Mary stumbled through her speech and fled from the stage.

stumble (up)on someone or something Go to **stumble across** someone or something.

a **stumbling block** *Fig.* something that prevents or obstructs progress. ☐ We'd like to buy that house, but the high price is a stumbling block. ☐ Jim's age is a stumbling block to getting another job. He's over sixty.

stump for someone to go about making political speeches in support of someone. ☐ The vice president was out stumping for members of Congress who were running this term. ☐ Since all the politicians were out stumping for one another, there was no one in the capital to vote on important legislation.

stump someone to confuse or puzzle someone. ☐ I have a question that will really stump you. When was the Achaean League established?

sub for someone or something to substitute for someone or something. ☐ I have to sub for Roger at work this weekend. ☐ Will pliers sub for the wrench you wanted?

sub someone for someone else and **sub** something for something else to substitute someone for someone else or something for something else. ☐ I will sub Chuck for Roger for this next play only. ☐ We will sub the red ones for the blue ones.

subdivide something **into** something to divide something into parts. ☐ They subdivided the land into several valuable parcels. ☐ Sam tried to subdivide his large lot into three smaller lots, but the zoning commission wouldn't let him do it.

subject someone or something **to** something to cause someone to endure someone or something. ☐ I didn't mean to subject you to Uncle Harry. ☐ I am sorry I have to subject you to all this questioning.

subject to something likely to have something, such as a physical disorder. ☐ The sick man was subject to dizzy spells. ☐ I am subject to frequent headaches.

subjugate someone **to** someone to suppress someone in someone else's favor. ☐ The army sought to subjugate everyone to the king.

submerge someone or something **in** something to immerse someone or something in a liquid. □ *The preacher submerged Jeff in the water of the river as part of the baptism ceremony.* □ *Submerge the fish in the marinade for at least two hours.*

submerge someone or something **under** something to put someone or something below the surface of a liquid. □ *The maid submerged her mistress under the surface of the water for a moment and brought her up and dried her off.* □ *They submerged themselves under the surface of the water and had a look around.*

submit someone or something **to** something to allow someone or something to undergo the effects of something. □ *I hate to submit you to all this questioning, but that is the way we do things here.* □ *Don't submit your car to a lot of misuse.*

submit to something to surrender to something; to agree to something. □ *He submitted to the cross-examination.* □ *She will probably refuse to submit to surgery.*

subordinate someone or something **to** someone or something else to put someone in an inferior position to someone else; to put something in an inferior position to something else. □ *I am going to have to subordinate you to the other manager, because she has more experience.* □ *The first thing you learn is that you must subordinate yourself to your boss.*

subpoena someone **to** do something to formally deliver a document forcing someone to do something for a legal process. □ *The attorney subpoenaed a number of witnesses to testify.* □ *I subpoenaed four witnesses to appear but none of them showed up.*

subscribe to something **1.** to agree with a policy. □ *I don't subscribe to the scheme you have just described.* □ *You don't have to subscribe to the policy to accept it.* **2.** to hold a standing order for a magazine or other periodical, or for a computer service. □ *I subscribe to three magazines, and I enjoy them all.* □ *I don't subscribe to any of them anymore.*

subsist on something to exist on something; to stay alive on something. □ *We can barely subsist on this amount of money. We need more!* □ *They are able to do no more than subsist on what Mrs. Harris is paid.*

substitute for someone or something to serve as a replacement for someone or something. □ *I have to substitute for Roger at work this weekend.* □ *Do you think that this will substitute for the one you wanted?*

substitute someone **for** someone else and **substitute** something **for** something else to exchange someone or something for someone or something else; to replace someone or something with someone or something else. □ *Shall I substitute Fred for Mary in the front office?* □ *Please substitute fish for beef on my dinner order.*

subtract something **from** something else to deduct or take away something from something else. □ *Please subtract the cost of the meal from my fee.* □ *I demanded that they subtract the extra charge from my bill.*

succeed as something to flourish or prosper as a type of person. □ *I hope I succeed as a bank teller.* □ *Jamie succeeded as an investigator.*

succeed at something to prosper or flourish in some task. □ *I hope I can succeed at the task you have assigned me.* □ *I am sure you will succeed at it.*

succeed in something to prosper or flourish in some position or office. □ *I hope you succeed in your new job.* □ *We knew you would succeed in doing what you wanted to do.*

succeed someone **as** something to take the place of someone as something; to supplant someone in something. □ *Jeff will succeed Claude as president of the organization.* □ *You are not allowed to succeed yourself as president.*

succeed to something to fall heir to something; to take something over. □ *Carl will succeed to the throne when he is of age.* □ *Mary succeeded to the throne at the age of three months.*

succumb to something to yield to something, especially a temptation, fatal disease, a human weakness, etc. □ *He finally succumbed to his pneumonia.* □ *She did not succumb to the disease until she was very old.*

such and such someone or something whose name has been forgotten or should not be said. □ *Mary said that such and such was coming to her party, but I forgot their names.* □ *If you walk into a store and ask for such and such and they don't have it, you go to a different store.*

such as... for example. □ *Bill enjoys many kinds of fruit, such as apples, pears, and plums.* □ *Mary has many hobbies, such as swimming, bowling, and running.*

such as it is *Cliché* in the imperfect state that one sees it; in the less-than-perfect condition in which one sees it. □ *This is where I live. This is my glorious home—such as it is.* □ *I've worked for days on this report, and I've done the best that I can do. It's my supreme effort—such as it is.*

Such is life! That is the way things happen! (Usually in reference to an unfortunate outcome.) □ *Oh, well. Everything can't be perfect. Such is life!* □ *So I failed my test. Such is life! I can take it again some time.*

suck (some) brew and **suck (some) suds** *Sl.* to drink beer. □ *Wanna go suck some brew?* □ *I'm tired of sucking suds. Got any whisky?*

suck (some) suds Go to previous.

suck someone **in**^t and **take** someone **in**^t to deceive someone. □ *I try to shop carefully so that no one can take me in.* □ *I think that someone sucked in both of them. I don't know why they bought this car.*

suck someone or something **down**^t [for a vacuum or water currents] to pull someone or something downward. □ *The savage currents sucked the swimmers down to their death.* □ *The current sucked down the floating trees.*

suck someone or something **into** something and **suck** someone or something **in**^t [for a vacuum] to draw someone or something into something. □ *The whirlpool sucked the swimmers into the depths of the river.* □ *The whirlpool sucked in a swimmer.* □ *A whirlpool nearly sucked our canoe in.*

suck someone or something **under** [for a current or waves] to pull someone or something beneath the surface of the water. □ *The strong rip tide almost sucked me under!* □ *It almost sucked our boat under.*

suck someone's **hind tit** *Sl.* to be forced to do someone's bidding no matter how unpleasant or impossible. (Fig. on

the idea of the last of a litter of animals to get its mother's milk. Potentially offensive. Use only with discretion.) □ *What am I supposed to do—suck his hind tit?* □ *She acts like everybody has to suck her hind tit to keep their jobs.*

suck something from something to draw something out of something by the application of a vacuum. □ *Freddie used his straw to suck the last of the cola from the can.* □ *The machine sucked the water from the bottom of the barrel.*

suck something in[†] 1. *Lit.* to draw something into one's mouth by sucking. □ *She sucked the milk shake in so hard she nearly collapsed the straw.* □ *Liz sucked in the fresh air.* **2.** *Fig.* to draw in one's belly, gut, or stomach. □ *Suck that belly in!* □ *Suck in that gut!*

suck something up[†] to pick something up by suction, as with a vacuum cleaner, or through a straw. □ *Will this vacuum suck all this dirt up?* □ *The vacuum cleaner sucked up all the dirt.*

suck up to someone *Sl.* to attempt to gain influence with or favor from someone. □ *In school, Richard was always sucking up to the teacher.* □ *Don't suck up to me. It won't do any good.*

a sucker for someone or something someone who is prejudiced in favor of someone or something; someone who is drawn to someone or something. □ *I'm a sucker for a pretty face.* □ *Ted is a sucker for any dessert with whipped cream on it.* □ *I don't know why I volunteered for this job. I'm a sucker for punishment I guess.*

sucker list *Fig.* a list of potential dupes; a list of people who might be taken in by deception. □ *I'm sure on their sucker list. They are trying to get me to give a lecture and receive a free clock or something.* □ *Here's the sucker list. Call them all and try to get them interested.*

sucker someone into something and **sucker someone in[†]** *Sl.* to deceive someone into some sort of scam or confidence game; to play someone for a fool. □ *Surely you don't think you can sucker me into doing something as stupid as that, do you?* □ *The con artist suckered in an unsuspecting tourist.*

suddenly the fat hit the fire *Go to the fat hit the fire.*

sue for something to file a lawsuit in order to get something. □ *If you so much as harm a hair on my head, I will sue for damages.* □ *Ted sued for back pay in his dispute with a former employer.*

sue someone for something to file a lawsuit against someone in order to get something. □ *I will sue you for damages if you do anything else to my car!* □ *She sued her employer for failure to provide a safe workplace.*

sue the pants off (of) someone *Sl.* to sue someone for a lot of money. (*Of* is usually retained before pronouns.) □ *If they harm me in any way, I'll sue the pants off of them.* □ *He sued the pants off his landlord.*

suffer a setback to have a minor or temporary failure. □ *We suffered a setback when much of our vineyard was damaged by a fungus.*

suffer an attack (of an illness) *Go to an attack (of an illness).*

suffer from something to endure or experience unpleasantness, a disease, or a health condition. □ *Jeff is suffering from the flu.* □ *I'm afraid that you must suffer from*

the disease until it has run its course. □ *Toby is really suffering from the cold.*

suffer under someone to endure the punishments or bad treatment of someone. □ *The citizens suffered badly under the rule of the cruel king.* □ *We suffered under Carlos and we will suffer under his successor.*

suffice for someone or something to be sufficient for someone or something. □ *This serving will suffice for me. Did you get enough?* □ *Will this suffice for you?*

Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof. *Prov.* You should not worry about things that might happen in the future.; It is enough to worry about things that are happening today. (Biblical.) □ *Jane: I can't get to sleep; I keep thinking about the interview I have to do tomorrow. Alan: If the interview is tomorrow, worry about it tomorrow. Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof.*

suffix something onto something to add an inflection or other part of a word onto another word. □ *The students were told to suffix the correct plural marker onto all the nouns in the list.* □ *What do you get when you suffix -ed onto a verb like talk?*

suffuse something with something to saturate something with something, usually a color. □ *The sun suffused the afternoon sky with orange and yellow.* □ *The bright light suffused the leaves with a golden glow.*

suggest itself to someone [for an idea] to seem to present itself to someone. □ *A new scheme suggested itself to Alice as she looked at the records of the last attempt.* □ *As you read this, does anything suggest itself to you?*

suggest something to someone to make a suggestion of something to someone. □ *The waiter suggested the roast beef to all his customers.* □ *What did you suggest to the people at the other table? They look quite pleased with their meal.*

***suggestive of something** reminiscent of something; suggesting something. (*Typically: **be ~; become ~**.) □ *Bill's homemade soup is suggestive of his mother's.* □ *The new movie was suggestive of an old one I had seen on TV.*

suit one's actions to one's words to behave in accordance with what one has said; to do what one has promised or threatened to do. □ *Mr. Smith suited his actions to his words and punished the children.* □ *John threatened to quit, and when he didn't get his way, he suited his actions to his words.*

suit oneself to do something one's own way; to do something to please oneself. □ *If he doesn't want to do it my way, he can suit himself.*

suit (oneself) up to get into one's uniform, especially an athletic uniform. □ *The coach told the team to suit up for the game by three o'clock.* □ *It's time to suit up!* □ *She suited herself up and went out on the court.*

suit someone or something to something to match someone or something to something. □ *I am sorry, but we don't suit the worker to the job. We find a job that suits the worker.* □ *Let's try to suit a new sports jacket to the slacks you have on.*

suit someone's fancy to appeal to someone's imagination, fantasy, or preferences. □ *Does this handbag suit your fancy, or would you prefer something larger?* □ *I think a big bowl of ice cream would suit my fancy quite nicely.*